



JACKSON and LINN: IF YOU FAIL *to* PLAN...

The financial troubles of the third couple discussed in this book, Jackson and Linn Reede, look at first as if they were the result of circumstances the couple could not control. Surely no one could have foreseen the medical problems their son would have or that the bills for his care would be so high. An argument could be made that the expenses they had for him would have wrecked anyone's budget.

But the fact is that Jackson and Linn's financial troubles were the result of poor planning. Although they were intelligent and committed people, they had never been taught the basics of finances. They had never measured Jackson's income against normal monthly expenses, and they had made no provision for any emergency spending they might someday have to make. The only way the couple made it financially was to use Linn's income to balance the budget.

This basic fact was not obvious to Jackson and Linn, and as a consequence, the steps they took as they began to slip into debt were ones that made a bad situation worse.